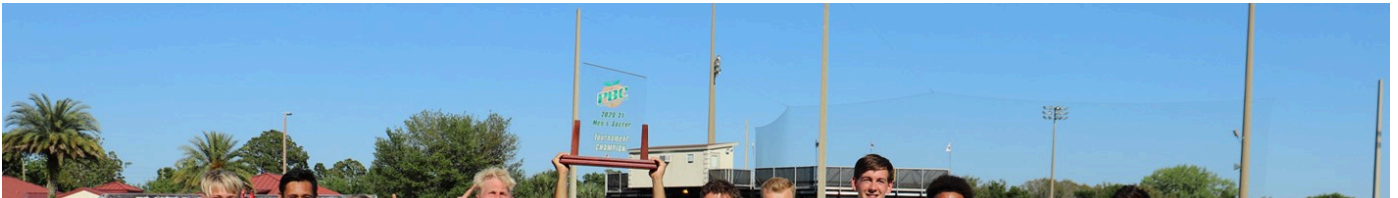




MEN'S SOCCER



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FLAGLER MEN'S SOCCER WINS PBC TOURNAMENT TITLE FOR FIRST TIME SINCE 2011

4/12/2021 8:30:00 PM

SAINTS TURN 2-2 TIE INTO A 5-4 PK SHOOTOUT VICTORY OVER FRANCIS MARION



ST. AUGUSTINE, Fla. — In a season some never thought would happen, the Flagler College men's soccer team did the unimaginable.

Just over a month ago, the No. 3-seeded Saints went into No. 4-seeded Francis Marion University searching for the club's first win and left with just that as they scored a pair of goals within six minutes to stun the home Patriots. It was the same grit Flagler showed in a season-opening tie



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That same fight shone through again Monday as the Saints mirrored its PBC Tournament semifinal upset win Wednesday at No. 2-seeded Young Harris College with another PK shootout victory, except this one was for the trophy. Flagler turned a come-from-behind, 2-2 tie into a 5-4 PK shootout win over Francis Marion once again as MVP Andrea Lubbja swatted away the final save to earn the Saints' first PBC Tournament title since 2011.

"It's been a tough year all around, but in hindsight we are thankful for the adversity we have faced," Flagler head coach Chris Kranjc said. "It helped to cultivate the spirit that this team has shown throughout the season. From overcoming injuries, to overcoming COVID, schedule changes and many more issues, the team was able to create a bond and togetherness that helped us end the season on a high.

"Andrea became a huge player for us during our playoff run and pulled off some amazing saves when it really mattered, non-more so than in the penalty shootouts. Extremely proud of this team and everything they have accomplished, winning the first title in 10 years is an incredible achievement!"

With the victory, Flagler becomes the first school to win both the men's and women's PBC Tournament titles since 2005 when Clayton State University did the same. The Saints (4-2-3) made history happen versus the Patriots (4-3-4) much like they have all season: in the final moments.

As the clock ticked down under 10 minutes, Joran Osland connected with Chris Stokes via a free kick as the lanky, 6-foot-5 defender got a header on it for the equalizer in the 82nd minute. Both of Flagler's goals came after a substitution, with the first coming after Al Cooper checked in ahead of his goal — assisted by Peik Koskinen — that came from the right and he tucked into the left post at the 38th minute.

The shots were equal across the board as Flagler had 14 and FMU had 15; however, the Patriots



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high gear.

Lubbia had six saves compared to Maximiliano Rocco's two and proved his dominance in the shootout for the second straight playoff PK victory. After Eden Shachar, Max Lambertz, Jed Bowman, Matteo Costa, and Al Cooper netted their kicks, the MVP made the title-clinching save to cap an unforgettable season for the Saints.

All-Tournament Team

Jed Smith, Lander

Samuel Maardh, Lander

Val Feeney, Young Harris

Alex Gschuend, Young Harris

Mauricio Castorino, FMU

Jafet Santiago, FMU

Sebastian Garcia, FMU

Jed Bowman, Flagler

Matteo Costa, Flagler

Max Lambertz, Flagler

Andrea Lubbia, MVP, Flagler

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